
ROGUE'S FREE
CHARACTER CREATION OUTLINE
LINK IN BIO!

Welcome to Rogue's Character Creation Outline!

This document aims to ignite your creativity and enhance your Dungeons and Dragons campaigns whether you are a player or DM. Here you can find guides and advice on how to improve your D&D Character, and in depth explanations of various topics pertaining to the character creation process, as well as character ideas and inspiration that I have used (or will use) in my games/past campaigns!. You are more than welcome to use these characters as NPCs as well!

Free Demo! This is a demo of my Ultimate Guide to Character Creation, so if you like what you see, consider supporting me and checking it out! The documentation has over 50 pages (formatted like this one!) and is updated weekly!

If you have any questions, reach out to me and I'll do my best to help out in a timely manner! Please do not copy, post, resell, plagiarize, infringe, etc. on my work. I worked very hard on this and hope you use it for its intended usage.

Social Medias

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My Rules of D&D Character Creation

Yes, I have rules for myself that I would love to share with you. Obviously, you don't have to follow them, but these rules have helped me a TON with making interesting characters in D&D as well as ensuring they are incorporated to the best of my DM's ability.

Rule 1: Communication.
TALK TO YOUR DM I AM BEGGING YOU. Communicating with your DM will solve so many issues before they can have the chance to come up. Want to know if they're running a campaign that will focus on the characters? Talk to your DM. Is there something you would like to see in your campaign? Talk to your DM. Want to connect your character to the world before the campaign starts? Talk. To. Your. DM. They are going to be just as eager as you are to get things going! I always make sure to communicate with my DM to get an idea of what kind of campaign we will be running before creating a character because in the past I have put a ton of effort into a character just for it to never have been explored in the first place since it was a combat-based campaign. I always run my character by my DM before starting the campaign or during session 0 to make sure they're good with it. It never hurts :)

Rule 2: Invest in your Character Just Like the DM is Investing in the Campaign.
Your DM puts a lot of work into the campaign you are playing in, so you have a responsibility to contribute to the game. When every player (or the majority) in the campaign puts effort into the character-building process and works on the growth of their character throughout the campaign, it makes the D&D experience infinitely more fun. Not to mention, this is how memories are made in D&D. My friends and I still talk about moments in our campaigns years later because of the collective effort we all put into the campaign.

Rule 3: Your Character is not Perfect. Embrace it.
I know how exciting it is to imagine what a character will become while you are writing it, but just remember that there's

a very good chance your character may go an entirely different route than you expected when you play it. Your character may have holes in its story, may have things you are unable to bring up in the campaign, and may be weak in some areas of combat/roleplaying, all of which are 100% okay! Make the most out of your weaknesses, it makes D&D fun!

Rule 4: Remember That you are Not the Only Character in the Campaign

I know you put in all of this effort to create your awesome character, but you also are playing with other people. D&D is a collaborative game and everyone deserves a chance to be in the spotlight. Remember that just because you have proficiency, doesn't mean you have to do every single roll pertaining to that.

Rule 5: Do NOT Fudge your Stats

I understand wanting to have a strong and well rounded character, but fudging your rolls is not the way to go. There is never a reason to do this, it's just straight-up cheating and makes it unfair for everyone else at the table. ReRolling your stats is fine as long as your DM is okay with it, but you should never ever fudge your stat rolls.

How Can I be a Better D&D Player?

Keep in mind that everyone has their own way to play D&D. Why do you think there are so many different classes/races/abilities? There is no “one size fits all” in D&D. Sometimes you are in a lighthearted and fun campaign where jokes are encouraged, other times you may be in a serious and dark campaign with content from a rated-R movie. In this segment, I’m going to give advice on how you can improve being a D&D Player to make the experience more enjoyable for everyone!

Player Agency: In D&D, player agency is the ability for players to make meaningful choices that influence the story, world, and the actions of their characters. Player Agency takes some of the work out of the DM’s hands and allows players to shape the events of the game, rather than reacting to a predetermined storyline or a railroaded plot. You as the player have the freedom to decide how your character reacts in various situations within the constraints of the DM. Player Agency also allows the story to evolve based on the actions and decisions of the players, creating an interactive narrative to allow players to shape how the world reacts to them. It’s also all about approaching challenges with creativity instead of being given a single solution to a problem – you have all of those skills and spells for a reason! Decisions can also have long term effects for the campaign and world!

Understand your Character: The DM has a lot of things to keep track of, so knowing your character and the abilities you have contributes a ton to the flow of the game as well as lifting weight off of your DM’s shoulders. Obviously you are allowed to mess up, but it can be frustrating to the table when you constantly have to read up on your spells and what they do in the middle of combat…

Stay Engaged: You don’t go to a movie theater to play on your phone for the entire time, so why would you doomscroll when your DM has worked hard to prepare a D&D session for you? You don’t need to be constantly doing something in game to stay engaged, all

you need to do is listen, interact, and ask questions.

Respect the Rules, but be flexible: The nice thing about D&D is that the core rules are more of a suggestion, most DMs don't even use all of the 5e rules! House Rules can come up when you least expect them to as well, which give a fresh and unique way to play D&D. Almost every DM I have met has a list of house rules that are unique to them! Social rules are a big part about D&D as well, knowing when to act and what your role is in combat will help the efficiency in the group! Nobody wants to be spoken over or cut off when they are given a chance to stand out!

Encourage and Support Others: D&D is a team game! You should celebrate with your fellow players when they succeed whether it be a creative combat strategy, unexpected nat 20, or well executed roleplay! It's important to engage with the story and contribute, but remember to share the spotlight with other players and allow everyone to have a chance to shine! Remember, just because you have proficiency in a skill, doesn't mean you have to make every roll for it!

Where Do I Start In Character Creation?

There are a ton of ways to start with creating a character, especially for D&D. Some people start at the beginning, creating a cool D&D character and then making a backstory for them after the fact. Others (like me) start backward or in the middle, picking the class first or starting with an idea, then going through the process. There is no right or wrong way to go about character creation, but here's an outline you can use to make sure you have everything covered. I'll have a blank copy of this outline after the example! Remember to visit the rest of the document if you run out of ideas or want to add anything else! :)

Example Outline

Start with an Idea: A character who hates Goblins!

Expand your Idea: He hates Goblins and he swore to destroy all of them.

Who are they outside of your Idea?: A lowly farmer with a family

Apply your Idea: He hates goblins because they steal his crops.
(Backstory applied here)
Go Deeper: His family went hungry all winter because the goblins stole and the guards refused to help him.

What is going to be done to fix it?: He will find and join a local adventuring group to become stronger and slay every goblin he crosses paths with.

Apply a Class: Paladin or Warlock. Paladin because he made an oath to destroy every goblin in his path. Warlock because maybe a patron saw his hatred and made a deal to give him power to slay goblins

(Now that we have an idea, let's continue to establish this character)

Name: John Greenhardt

Age: 35

Gender: Male

Race/Species: Wood-Elf

Occupation: Farmer

Home Town: Meadhaven *(Work with your DM on your hometown to tie your character to the world!)*

Economic Status: Comfortable

Education: Dropped out of school to follow in his father's footsteps as a farmer, he feels he has mastered the trade.

(Let's move on to appearance!)

Height: 5'10

Weight: 185

Hair Style: Long, usually tied back

Hair Color: Grey

Eye Color: Orange

Body Type: Muscular dad bod

Fitness Level: Blue Collar Strength

Scars/Birthmarks: Scar across his face that was left the first time he defended his home against goblins

Tattoos: Family crest on left shoulder blade

(Who's in their life?)

Lover/Partner: Wife, Gretta Greenhardt

Parents: Retired happily

Children: I have two amazing daughters

Friends: Many friends have be made in the countryside of Meadhaven

Rivals: Julian Cobbleron, the farmer from across the way.

Enemies: The Goblins

(Personality)

Traits: Humble, kind, wise, resilient

Flaws: Bossy, stubborn

Hobbies: He is a painter on his free time, he has created murals on his walls

Skills/Talents: Won the Farmers' Games last year by carrying 4 Barrels on his back

Morals: Family first, even when they're in the wrong.

Bad Habits: Comfortable with being dirty, too comfortable

Phobias: Slight fear of spiders

Accent and Voice: slightly deep and steady tone, medieval accent

(Let's look at their past)

Criminal Record: None, he has always avoided crime the best he could

Dark Secret: His family has the secrets to grow the perfect crops, but he doesn't share it despite these secrets being able to change the world.

Affiliations: Farmers' Guild

Notable Events: The goblins first attack on his farm, all of the crops they stole and animals they slaughtered. It changed his perspective on outsiders.

Character Creation Outline

Start with an Idea: _____

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Expand your Idea: _____

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_____

Who are they outside of your Idea?:

_____

_____

Apply your Idea: _____

_____

Backstory applied here

Go Deeper: _____

_____

_____

What is going to be done to fix it?:

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_____

Apply a Class:

_____

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_____

Name:

_____

Age: _____

Gender: _____

Race/Species:

_____

Occupation:

_____

Home Town:

_____

Economic Status:

_____

Education:

_____

Let's move on to appearance!

Height:_____

Weight:_____

Hair Style:

_____

Hair Color:

_____

Eye Color:

_____

Body Type:

_____

Fitness Level:

_____

Scars/Birthmarks:

_____

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_____

Tattoos:

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Who's in their life?

Lover/Partner:

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Personality

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Morals:

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Bad Habits:

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Phobias:

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Accent and Voice:

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Let's look at their past

Criminal Record:

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Dark Secret:

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Affiliations:

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Notable Events:

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Fan Favorite Characters

MIA or AWOL?: A character that used to be a soldier before he faked his death and went MIA. He took up a career in adventuring to create a new name for himself, but his Commanding Officer is searching for him…

- Why is the Officer Searching for him? To kill him? To reunite? To bring him back to the army?
- Does he have any defining scars that will give away his identity?

Recommended Class(es): *Any form of martial*

The Ultimate Entertainer: A Warlock whose patron becomes stronger depending on how much entertainment and positivity is generated. This character became a magician who performed with a traveling circus.

- How does this character view their patron?
- Why did this character join the circus? Why did this character *leave* the circus to adventure?

Recommended Class(es): *Warlock, maybe a bard multiclass to give off a jester vibe*

Following My Brother's Footsteps: A Character whose Older Brother is the hero of legends, but he died in a recent adventure with you. No one knows of his death aside from you, and you vowed you would avenge your brother and continue his legacy under his name rather than your own.

- Would your Brother have wanted this?
- Perfect for a campaign where you start with a magic item
- This character will have to impersonate their brother, so when roleplaying – slip up here and there! A nice flaw for this character would be that they lack confidence when they are not impersonating their brother.
- If you would like to play an evil version of this character, have your character be the one who killed your brother.
- Write out a statblock for your Brother and give it to your DM to help you world build!

Recommended Class(es): *Technically any class would work here, but I had a Fighter in mind.*

He's My Son…: A character whose son became a thing of nightmares. He has embarked on a quest to hunt down his son to right his wrongs, help those he hurt, and put him to rest for good before it's too late.

- Typically this character will be older and more mature. Give him memories of his son before he became evil that he can share with the party.
- Will you be able to deal the finishing blow when the time comes?
- Maybe you don't want it to be your son, feel free to change it to a sibling, a parent, or even a friend.

Recommended Class(es): *Any class*

Left for Dead: A Mercenary who was hired by the adventuring group. He was left behind after being injured. All hope was lost until he was found by the party of PCs

- Will you work to repay your debts to those who saved you, or instantly seek out revenge?
- How badly were you injured? What injured them? This injury can last and be a part of your character's flaws.

Recommended Class(es): *Any class works but I had martial classes in mind.*

Enemy to the Gods: A character who had pushed his limits as a mortal, challenging the gods themselves and winning, he is the chosen one to bring order to the universe. The Gods stopped him, erasing his memory entirely as punishment for meddling with godhood.

- You could give this character the hercules effect, where he has extraordinary powers but does not know what he's capable of so he lives a normal life
- There's a lot of flexibility with this character

Recommended Class(es): *Any class, I think a martial or a half caster would fitting*

The End

Hey there :)

I want to take a moment to express gratitude to you, the reader, for checking out this demo of my product “Rogue’s Ultimate Guide to Character Creation”. I remember watching Markiplier on youtube when he had first started in the early 2010s and little me was inspired to become a content creator because of him. I wanted to create a community and spread positivity with my videos. Though I never expected that I would become a D&D Content creator, I wouldn’t give this up for the world. Your support goes a long way and I am forever grateful for the platform I have.

Anyways If you liked what you saw on this guide, consider checking out the full version "Rogue's Ultimate Guide to Character Creation". It goes in depth on the character creation process in Dungeons and Dragons, has more segments, more Character inspiration, and best of all -- **UPDATED WEEKLY**!

Keep working hard!
–Michael “RogueMDF”

P.S. Check out my discord, it is full of D&D players, gamers, and gym goers. There are a ton of different channels and awesome people that are more than willing to make new friends and chat about D&D. It’s the best way to chat with me too!

Ultimate Guide to Character Creation: https://roguemdf.com/shop/Characters
Discord: https://discord.gg/YmcjwQ2PJy